

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called 'The Heap of Jewels'

Ārya-ratnārāśi-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 88 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྩི་པ་ཆེན་པོ་ལྷན་པ་

Toh 88 in the Kangyur is the forty-fourth chapter of a vast Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-ratnārāśi-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra and in Tibetan as Phags pa rin po che'i phung po, rendered in English as "The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called 'The Heap of Jewels.'" This chapter, titled "The Prophecy of the Noble Heap of Jewels," belongs to the broader collection known as the Great Jewel Heap, a massive compendium of Dharma teachings comprising one hundred thousand chapters, and it takes the form of a canonical Mahāyāna discourse set on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha, where the Buddha addresses an assembly of thousands of monks and bodhisattvas gathered from many buddha-fields. As its title suggests, the chapter is concerned with prophetic teachings, delivered to an audience of highly advanced bodhisattvas who stand only a single lifetime away from perfect awakening. Situated within the Kangyur's collection of Mahāyāna sūtras, this text represents one section of a sprawling scriptural corpus that was preserved and transmitted as part of the Tibetan Buddhist canonical tradition.

The Noble Great Jewel Heap: a chapter on the prophecy of the noble heap of jewels, being the forty-fourth chapter of the hundred-thousand-chapter Dharma categories of the Noble Great Jewel Heap. First fascicle.

In the language of India: Ārya-ratnārāśi-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the Tibetan language: The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called "The Heap of Jewels."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great Saṅgha of some eight thousand monks, and with sixteen thousand bodhisattvas assembled from various buddha-fields. All of them without exception had attained the forbearance of non-regression, being separated from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening by only a single birth.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by what means is one called a wandering ascetic, a wandering ascetic?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Mahākāśyapa as follows:

"Kāśyapa, one is called a wandering ascetic by reason of being peaceful and tamed, by knowing, by having a thoroughly purified aggregate of moral discipline, by knowing how to enter into meditative absorption, by being endowed with wisdom, by applying oneself to the essence of liberation, by having no wavering or doubt with regard to the three gateways of liberation, by dwelling in the domain of the noble ones, by dwelling in the four applications of mindfulness, by dwelling in the four genuine abandonments, by having cultivated the four bases of miraculous power, by being endowed with the faculty of faith, by having unshakeable faith in the Buddha, unshakeable faith in the Dharma, unshakeable faith in the Saṅgha, by being endowed with faith in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha through understanding, by being endowed with a knowledge that does not depend on others, by having aroused diligence with respect to virtuous phenomena, by having overcome existence, by being properly entered, by being skilled in mindfulness and vigilance, by having a one-pointed mind, by being skilled in insight through wisdom, by being endowed with the five powers, by being unpolluted by all afflictions, by being absorbed in the seven limbs of awakening, by being skilled in knowing the supports of phenomena, by knowing the path, by being skilled in the path, by right view, by right meditative absorption, by being skilled in cultivating calm abiding and insight, by being endowed with a wisdom in the four perfect individual knowledges that does not depend on others, by relying on the meaning rather than on the letter, by relying on gnosis rather than on ordinary consciousness, by relying on sūtras of definitive meaning rather than on sūtras of interpretable meaning, by relying on the nature of reality rather than on the person, by having thoroughly passed beyond the path of the four māras, by protecting the thorough understanding of the aggregates, by dispelling afflictions, by bearing the final body, by having genuinely passed beyond the path of the lord of death, by thoroughly understanding suffering in full, by having abandoned all arising, by being entered into the direct realization of cessation, by being entered into the subsequent practice of the yoga of cultivating the path, by having seen the Four Noble Truths, by not depending on others, by having accomplished what was to be done in the Teacher's teaching, by having done what needed to be done, by having exhausted the defilements, by being absorbed in the eight liberations, by being received by Śakra (Indra), by Brahmā, and by the world-protectors, by

the excellence of previous conduct and intention, by having genuine delight in dwelling in solitude, by dwelling in the noble lineage, and by dwelling in the qualities of refinement —"

by being without deceit, by having gone forth and not mingling with the life of the household, by wandering alone like a rhinoceros horn, by being frightened of crowds and gatherings, by being fully liberated from all three realms without exception, by constantly holding a mind of fearful caution, by abiding in the way of a true ascetic, by being without desire toward anything, by having genuinely transcended the eight worldly concerns — gain and loss, fame and obscurity, pleasure and suffering, praise and blame — by abiding through cultivation with a mind equal to the earth, by protecting both oneself and others, by being without confusion, by being without agitation, by being rightly entered, by abiding through cultivation with a mind equal to space, by having a mind that is neither attached to nor bound by any mark or sign whatsoever — just as the palm of a hand does not cling to or become bound by space — if an ascetic, O Kāśyapa, is endowed with such qualities as these, that one is rightly called an ascetic, truly an ascetic.

Then the venerable great Kāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha has so thoroughly and completely set forth these qualities of a true ascetic. Blessed One, in a future time, will there be any monks who, while not being true ascetics, claim to be ascetics, and while not living the holy life, claim to live the holy life — monks who are able to accomplish what those capable of genuinely fulfilling the Tathāgata's awakening over incalculable eons accomplish?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kāśyapa, when I and you and these great hearers have passed into nirvāṇa, and when these bodhisattvas have gone to other buddha-fields, this teaching will enter into thorough decline — that much cannot be expressed in words. Kāśyapa, at that time there will appear certain monks who have not cultivated body, have not cultivated moral discipline, have not cultivated mind, have not cultivated wisdom — who are childish, inferior, foolish, not thoroughly pacified, and untamed. Of them, one must speak of their dishonesty, their deceit, their crookedness, their duplicity, the stains of the ascetic, and the faults of the ascetic.

"Kāśyapa, what then are the stains of the ascetic? Kāśyapa, the following thirty-two are the stains of the ascetic. If one abandons these, one is rightly

called an ascetic, truly an ascetic.

"What are the thirty-two? Conceptual thought of desire is a stain of the ascetic. Conceptual thought of ill will is a stain of the ascetic. Conceptual thought of harmfulness is a stain of the ascetic. Praising oneself is a stain of the ascetic. Belittling others is a stain of the ascetic. Seeking gain by improper means is a stain of the ascetic. Wishing to obtain gain by means of gain is a stain of the ascetic. Squandering what has been given in faith is a stain of the ascetic. Concealing one's transgressions is a stain of the ascetic. Associating closely with householders is a stain of the ascetic. Associating closely with those who have gone forth is a stain of the ascetic. Taking delight in crowds and gatherings is a stain of the ascetic. Thinking that one's gain is not yet fully accomplished is a stain of the ascetic. Not being content with one's own gain is a stain of the ascetic. Being jealous and miserly toward others' receipt of alms is a stain of the ascetic. Coveting another's gain is a stain of the ascetic. Not recognizing one's own errors is a stain of the ascetic."

Seeking out the faults of others is a stain of the ascetic. Not guarding the rules of individual liberation (prātimokṣa) and the Vinaya is a stain of the ascetic. Speaking babble like a crow is a stain of the ascetic. Disrespectfulness, recklessness, and arrogance are a stain of the ascetic. Being thoroughly bound by views is a stain of the ascetic. Contradicting dependent origination is a stain of the ascetic. Abiding in extreme views is a stain of the ascetic. Delighting in saṃsāra is a stain of the ascetic. Not delighting in nirvāṇa is a stain of the ascetic. Holding the secret words of worldly charlatans is a stain of the ascetic. Being thoroughly bound by obscurations is a stain of the ascetic. Contradicting the karmic maturation of actions is a stain of the ascetic. Being frightened by the three gates of liberation is a stain of the ascetic. Abandoning the profound Dharma is a stain of the ascetic. Dwelling in contradiction to the Dharma is a stain of the ascetic. Showing disrespect toward the Three Jewels is a stain of the ascetic. Kāśyapa, those thirty-two are the stains of the ascetic. If one has abandoned them, one is rightly called an ascetic.

Kāśyapa, these eight are the Dharma-obscurations of the ascetic. What are the eight? They are: disrespect toward one's teachers; showing no reverence toward the Dharma teachings; inappropriate attention; abandoning sūtra collections one has not yet heard; being frightened by the teaching of selflessness — that there is no sentient being, no life-force, no person; not entering into the teaching of unconditioned phenomena but instead pursuing only what is conditioned; being frightened upon hearing that formations are

unborn; and, upon hearing that all phenomena are unborn by inherent nature, falling as though plunging into a great abyss. Kāśyapa, those eight are the Dharma-obscurations of the ascetic, and one who has gone forth must completely abandon them.

Kāśyapa, I do not call someone an ascetic by the color or form of external marks. I say that one who applies oneself diligently to the qualities of the Dharma is an ascetic.

Kāśyapa, an ascetic should wear the ochre robes upon the body with a mind free of turbidity. Why? Because I permit the ochre robe to those who are free of turbidity. Kāśyapa, all those who, while turbid of mind, bear the ochre robes upon the body — they are said to be burning those ochre robes. Exceptions are made for those whose aspiration is one of devoted conviction. Why? Because that robe is the victory banner of the noble ones. These robes accord with the path of pacification and follow after loving-kindness; they are worn by those who dwell in weariness with saṃsāra and freedom from attachment.

Kāśyapa, what then is the victory banner of the noble ones? Kāśyapa, these twelve are the victory banner of the noble ones. What are the twelve? Kāśyapa: moral discipline is the victory banner of the noble ones; meditative absorption is the victory banner of the noble ones; wisdom is the victory banner of the noble ones; liberation is the victory banner of the noble ones; the vision of the gnosis of liberation is the victory banner of the noble ones; entry into truth is the victory banner of the noble ones; entry into dependent origination is the victory banner of the noble ones; the four meditative concentrations are the victory banner of the noble ones; the four immeasurables are the victory banner of the noble ones; the four absorptions of the formless realm are the victory banner of the noble ones; entry into the faultless is the victory banner of the noble ones; and the exhaustion of defilements is the victory banner of the noble ones.

These twelve are the victory banners of the noble ones, O Kāśyapa. Whoever among them, though lacking these victory banners, wears the ochre robes of the noble lineage on their body — that one, I say, has entered a corrupt teaching. That one, I say, abides in opposition to the Dharma. That one, I say, dwells far from the Tathāgata's teaching. That one, I say, abides on the side that is contrary to nirvāṇa. That one, I say, is aligned with the side of saṃsāra. That one, I say, is seized by the saliva of pride. That one, I say, has not taken up the essence. That one, I say, has fallen away from the Dharma. That one, I

say, abides on a wretched path.

Therefore, O Kāśyapa, when a monk wears the ochre robes on his body, he should do so with a mind free of turbidity. If he has not yet attained the fruit, he should wear the ochre robes on his body with these eight reverences. And what are the eight? The perception of the robes as a reliquary shrine, the perception of them as the Teacher, the perception of them as peace and quieting, the perception of them as loving-kindness, the perception of reverence toward the buddhas, the perception of moral shame, the perception of moral dread, and the thought: "I shall be free of turbidity." Because these eight reverences are in accord with the conduct of a monk, one should wear the ochre robes on one's body by means of them.

Those, O Kāśyapa, who are lax and undisciplined, and who wear ochre robes on their bodies while having fallen away from these qualities and virtues of monkhood — these persons do not give rise to these reverences.

O Kāśyapa, there exists a particular hell realm for feeble-minded sentient beings, called "the hell that harms those who have the color and form of a monk." In that hell realm for feeble-minded sentient beings, those who have taken on the form of a monk are tormented by burning robes, burning heads, burning bowls, burning seats, and burning bedding. Whatever belongings they have and whatever they make use of — all of these blaze, burn furiously, spread and flare, and become fire. They experience the harm of one who has the color and form of a monk. Why is that? Because they are endowed with impure actions of body, speech, and mind. Those who are endowed with such impure actions of body, speech, and mind — their very destiny too becomes utterly impure.

O Kāśyapa, one who is not a monk yet claims to be a monk, and one who does not live the holy life yet claims to live the holy life — if such a person appropriates to himself the veneration offered by those endowed with moral discipline and those endowed with virtuous qualities, that person, through this non-virtuous action, will obtain eight kinds of contempt. And what are the eight? They will become like a dullard; they will become sluggish and lazy; they will become a woman reviled by many people; they will become without independence and will become a slave; they will become ugly and displeasing in appearance; they will become known as ugly and of little power; no one whatsoever will draw near to them; and they will bring no joy to those who are worthy of offerings. These are the eight kinds of contempt they will obtain.

Therefore, O Kāśyapa, having heard of these sorts of unfavorable conditions, a sinful monk should not appropriate to himself the veneration offered by others. For, O Kāśyapa, one who is not a monk yet claims to be a monk, and who does not live the holy life yet claims to live the holy life — even the mere spitting of saliva's ash upon this great earth, I do not find to be approved; how much less the lifting and placing of a step upon it? Why is that? Because this great earth was given by the kings of former times for the purpose of being used by those endowed with moral discipline, those endowed with virtuous qualities, and those worthy of offerings.

O Kāśyapa, the placing and lifting of each and every step by that sinful monk — each and every one of those steps constitutes using without entitlement, as though against the will of the donor, things given out of faith: whether it be a seat belonging to the Saṅgha or the Saṅgha of the four directions, a throne or a small seat, a walking place, a bench, a dwelling, a temple, a pleasure garden or the ground of a pleasure garden, communal property, an alms bowl, robes, collected alms-food, bedding and furnishings, medicine for the sick, or any other requisite — he uses all of these without entitlement to things given in faith. How much more so, O Kāśyapa, is this the case! You should know this. You should take it thoroughly to heart.

O Kāśyapa, one who is not an ascetic (śramaṇa) yet claims to be an ascetic, and who does not live the holy life yet claims to live the holy life — such a one is incapable of purifying even so much as the tip of a hair's portion of things given in faith. Why is that? Because, O Kāśyapa, I have taught the noble Saṅgha to be like a great ocean, the supreme field of merit, the foremost among those worthy of gifts.

O Kāśyapa, when brahmin householders and faithful laypeople offer gifts to that Saṅgha with a sense of boundless significance, if that sinful monk of corrupt moral discipline were to consume even so much as a hundredth part of a hair's tip of things given in faith, then for the sake of purifying the giver and the donor, whatever amount of faith-given things he consumes — were it even a portion the size of a hair's tip — that amount of karmic debt accumulates into a vast ocean of karma. Therefore, O Kāśyapa, you should train thus: "We shall use things given in faith only with fully pure moral discipline."

When this teaching was spoken, two hundred monks of the Yogācāra tradition, having heard this teaching, wept aloud with tears streaming down, and said these words: "Even if we were to die, we would not, until we have attained the

fruit, consume even a single morsel of alms-food given in faith."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent, good men! Those who are adorned with such qualities — a sense of shame, remorse, and the fear of blame in the world beyond — they make this scripture beautiful."

"O Kāśyapa, I grant to two kinds of monks the right to use things given in faith. What are these two? Those who are endowed and those who are liberated. And again two: those who view all formations as impermanent, and those who enter into the meditative absorption of the mind's liberation through loving-kindness (maitrī).

"O monks, among these, the monk who is endowed, who practices Yogācāra, who has entered my teaching, and who — having used robes, alms-food, bedding and furnishings, medicine for the sick, and other requisites received from givers and donors — sees the fault of saṃsāra, sees all formations as impermanent, recognizes all formations as suffering, is convinced of the selflessness of all phenomena, and realizes that nirvāṇa is peaceful: even if such a monk were to consume gifts given in faith amounting to the size of Mount Meru, his repayment to the donor would be utterly pure. And those givers and donors from whom he has used things given in faith will thereby obtain the ripening of merit with great abundance and great benefit. Why is that? Because, O monks, among all merit-producing bases arising from material things, entering into meditative absorption with a mind of loving-kindness is supreme.

"O monks, whatever monk, having used the robes, alms-food, bedding, furnishings, and other requisites of givers and donors, enters into the boundless liberation of mind — know that the ripening of merit for those givers and donors is likewise boundless."

"O Kāśyapa, even if all the great oceans within this great trichiliocosm were to be utterly exhausted, the corresponding cause of merit for that person would never be exhausted at all.

"O Kāśyapa, consider the extent of the harm into which a person who is not confused — one who, after fully using things given in faith by givers and donors, falls into transgression through corrupt moral discipline — has entered. O Kāśyapa, therefore the stains of the śramaṇa, the faults of the śramaṇa, the dishonesty of the śramaṇa, the deceit of the śramaṇa, the cunning of the śramaṇa, the duplicity of the śramaṇa — all such things as these must be completely abandoned by the śramaṇa through purity of

intention.

"O Kāśyapa, as for the term 'śramaṇa, śramaṇa' — it refers to one from whose eye no defilements flow out, and likewise not from the ear, not from the nose, not from the tongue, not from the body, and not from the mind either. Therefore is one called 'śramaṇa, śramaṇa.' One who possesses the knowing of the six sense bases, the six direct knowledges, the six recollections, who dwells in respect toward the holy ones, and who dwells in the six Dharmas that lead to the far shore — therefore is one called 'śramaṇa, śramaṇa.'

This concludes the first chapter, the Chapter on the Śramaṇa.

"O Kāśyapa, as for the term 'monk (bhikṣu), monk' — one is called a monk because the afflictions have been vanquished. One who has vanquished the perception of self, the perception of sentient being, the perception of a living soul, the perception of a nourished one, the perception of a person, the perception of a male, the perception of a female, the perception of a boy, and the perception of a girl — therefore is one called 'monk, monk.' One who has cultivated the body, cultivated moral discipline, cultivated the mind, cultivated wisdom, who is without fear or dread, who has crossed the river of existence, who looks upon arising and ceasing, who is free from all terrors, and who dwells on the path of fearlessness — therefore is one called 'monk, monk.'

"O Kāśyapa, if there are those who, lacking these qualities, presume to claim 'I am a monk, a monk,' then — apart from those who aspire with sincere intention — I am not their Teacher, and they are not my śrāvakas.

"O Kāśyapa, it is mostly the wicked monks who will cause this teaching of mine to decline. O Kāśyapa, ninety-five wonders and all the attacks of opponents cannot cause this teaching of mine to decline. Rather, it is those who arise from within this very teaching of mine, those who lack discernment and who do not think with conviction — it is they who will cause my teaching to decline.

"O Kāśyapa, consider this example: no predator or bird can eat the flesh of the lion, king of beasts, once it has died; but whatever worms arise from within the very corpse of the lion, king of beasts — those worms eat the flesh of the lion, king of beasts. O Kāśyapa, in the same way, those who arise from within this very teaching of mine — the foolish and greedy, those overwhelmed by attachment, those holding wrong views, those who do not think with conviction, those who are lax, those who speak falsehood — it is they who will cause my teaching to decline.

"O Kāśyapa, if a monk possesses four qualities, he should be recognized as a wicked monk. What are the four? Attachment, aversion, delusion, and the pride that thinks 'I.' Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Arrogance, speaking harshly without restraint, being like a crow, and speaking lewdly. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Agitation, cowardice, craving for gain, and craving for what is not Dharma. Those are the four. And further, another four —"

What are the four? Deceitfulness, craftiness, sustaining oneself through improper means, and speaking without shame. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Not repaying kindness received, reviling those who have shown one kindness, failing to remember past kindnesses, and deceiving one's friends. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Causing the faithful offerings of donors to be wasted through transgression, not guarding moral discipline, degrading the prātimokṣa (the code of individual liberation), and not upholding the Vinaya. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Asserting the existence of a self, asserting the existence of a sentient being, asserting the existence of a life-force, and asserting the existence of a person. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Showing no reverence for the Buddha, showing no reverence for the Dharma, showing no reverence for the Saṅgha, and showing no reverence for the trainings. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Taking no delight in the harmony of the Saṅgha, finding no joy in the monastery, taking keen pleasure in crowds and commotion, and speaking the secrets of worldly outcasts. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Craving gain, craving fame, craving companions and associates, and finding no supreme delight in the Dharma. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Being seized by Māra, being oppressed by Māra, being torpid and given to excessive sleep, and not abiding in the lineage of the noble ones. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Having a body that is filthy and bejeweled with adornments, being struck through by afflictions, turning one's back on nirvāṇa, and attaining no fruit. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Being utterly consumed by the burning of attachment, being utterly consumed by the burning of aversion, being utterly consumed by the burning of delusion, and being utterly consumed by the burning of all afflictions. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Abiding on the wrong

path and not seeing the way out, having become miserly and possessing the manner of one who shares nothing, wishing to grasp at everything and knowing no contentment, and having never known satisfaction while being devoid of diligence in learning. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Inclining toward darkness and thus becoming dark, inclining toward confusion and thus becoming confused, being entangled by false Dharmas and perceiving what is not Dharma as Dharma, and having blocked the gateway to nirvāṇa, being bound by the fetters of saṃsāra. Those are the four. And further, another four — what are those four? Feigning conduct of body, feigning conduct of speech, feigning conduct of mind, and feigning conduct of deportment. Those are the four.

Now, feigning conduct of body means: feigning to walk slowly, feigning to hold one's head bowed, feigning to gaze no further ahead than the length of a yoke-beam, feigning to wear one's robes neatly and well, feigning the appearance of one who dwells in a hermitage without actually seeking the qualities of dwelling there, feigning the appearance of one gathering alms without having removed the perception of a lump of food, feigning to carry a fly-whisk as if in accordance with a sense of shame and conscience while not actually following shame and conscience, feigning to dwell at the foot of a cliff or the foot of a tree as if engaged in dependent origination while not actually engaging in it, and feigning to seek medicine to be strained and discarded while not seeking the medicine of the nectar of Dharma. This is called feigning conduct of body.

Now, what is feigning conduct of speech?

"Such a one is known to me as a person of high standing, and by reason of being known as such a person of high standing he invites me as a guest. Through me he obtains whatever he desires, having served him with respect, I obtain it. Through me he obtains what is excellent. Through me he obtains it many times over. Through me he hears much. I am endowed with moral discipline and am one who has virtuous qualities. I am worthy of being invited. I am worthy of being answered in return. I am capable, gifted, and powerful. I am skilled in teaching the definitive meaning of things." Whatever is said to him by the one known as a person of high standing, after he has spoken to that person in this way he cuts off that person's confidence, leaving him without boldness. He delights his retinue. He obtains praise. He obtains a share of that person's goods. He seeks hospitality so that he may come again. Kāśyapa, all such vain speech as arises from a mind not dwelling in right

intention — this is feigning conduct of speech. It belongs to the realm of the unreasonable, not to the realm of the reasonable. This is called feigning conduct of speech.

Kāśyapa, what then is feigning conduct of mind? It is when one's mind inwardly considers it quite acceptable to obtain a robe or alms, yet with one's words says "I have no need of anything whatsoever," and when one's mind desires to receive gain yet one speaks words claiming to desire little. This is called feigning conduct of mind.

On this, the following is said:

In mind one thinks "Why not — let me have it,"
yet in words one says "I need nothing at all."
Speaking thus with a mind of hollow pretense,
one shall never come to find lasting happiness.
Through the intent of feigning conduct of mind
one deceives the gods, the nāgas, and the divine-eyed ones.
With a mind of such speech one's stream shall never be purified.
All the Tathāgatas know this perfectly.

Kāśyapa, thus when monks who are endowed with what is contrary to Dharma and who are evil engage in conduct of this kind — conduct that is not their proper domain — they shall go to the hells, to the realm of rebirth as animals, and to the world of Yama, the Lord of Death.

This concludes the second chapter, the chapter on monks.

Kāśyapa, what is a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste? Kāśyapa, consider this: an outcaste always frequents charnel grounds; he looks to the dead for his sustenance, he gazes upon living beings with eyes devoid of loving-kindness, and he delights in death. Kāśyapa, in just the same way a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste always haunts the households of his friends and companions and the households of those who give alms. From these he sustains himself with gain and honor, yet he does not lead those householders to uphold the Dharma or the Vinaya properly. He cultivates familiarity with them for the sake of gain and not for their true benefit. He has no mind of genuine affection and always pins his hopes on gain. Kāśyapa, this is called a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste.

Kāśyapa, consider this: an outcaste is always to be utterly shunned by merchants, householders, ministers, regional kings, brahmins, nobles,

townspeople, and villagers alike. Knowing one to be an outcaste, they shun him from even farther away than one would shun an ordinary person at a distance. Kāśyapa, in just the same way a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste is to be utterly shunned by monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen who are endowed with moral discipline and endowed with good qualities. Knowing that this śramaṇa who is like an outcaste engages in all evil qualities and violates moral discipline, they shun him from even farther away than one would shun an ordinary outcaste at a distance.

Kāśyapa, consider this: all the napkins, garments, and used articles of an outcaste are things that persons of noble birth will not touch and will not make use of.

Kāśyapa, in just the same way the begging bowl, robes, and all the used articles of a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste are things sought out by living a livelihood that is not in harmony with the Dharma, sought out at the cost of wounding body and mind — and so those who are endowed with moral discipline and endowed with good qualities will not touch them and will not make use of them.

Kāśyapa, consider this: an outcaste takes up a rag and, making himself humble and crouching low, goes to the houses of others. Kāśyapa, in just the same way a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste also, making himself humble and crouching low, pays homage at the stūpas of the Tathāgata; making himself humble and crouching low, he enters into the midst of the assembly; making himself humble and crouching low, he goes to the temple, to the dwelling, and to the houses of others; and making himself humble and crouching low, he walks about, sits, and lies down. Kāśyapa, all the conduct of one who is thus humble and crouching low, concealing his wrongdoing, is born entirely of what is improper.

Kāśyapa, consider this: the mind of an outcaste does not abide in taking rebirth among the happy destinies. Why is that? It is because of the fault of his own karma. Kāśyapa, in just the same way the mind of a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste likewise does not abide so as to go to the happy destinies; his next world is thoroughly darkened and obscured; and there is nothing to prevent him from remaining in the three lower realms. Kāśyapa, this is called a śramaṇa who is like an outcaste.

Kāśyapa, as for the śramaṇa who is rotten — Kāśyapa, consider this: a drink of supreme flavour, fit for a king, that has been infused with the finest essences,

yet whose remnants have become putrid and unclean, is not something to be tasted. Kāśyapa, in just the same way a rotten śramaṇa is one who is devoid of the flowing taste of the supreme essence of the Dharma, who stinks, and who is worthy of being completely abandoned. He possesses the foul and unpleasant odour of affliction, of guile and deceit, and of corrupt moral discipline, and he is devoid of the fragrance of moral discipline; he is suffused with the stench of afflictions. Wherever he goes, he enters only for his own benefit, not for the benefit of others. Kāśyapa, this is called a rotten śramaṇa.

Kāśyapa, consider this: what is called "rotten" — whatever has been eaten, drunk, seasoned, and left as leavings is putrid and foul-smelling, and is worthy of being completely abandoned by all persons of noble birth. Kāśyapa, in just the same way a rotten śramaṇa is comparable to such leavings: because his conduct of body, speech, and mind is thoroughly impure, he is worthy of being completely abandoned by noble persons. This is called a rotten śramaṇa.

Kāśyapa, consider this: a seed that is rotten cannot properly sprout from the great earth. Kāśyapa, in just the same way a rotten śramaṇa likewise does not sprout within this teaching of the Buddha; the seed of the noble Dharma of liberation has no potency in him, and he will not come to attain the fruit. Kāśyapa, this is called a rotten śramaṇa.

Kāśyapa, as for the śramaṇa who is like a basket — Kāśyapa, consider this: there is a basket that is beautifully polished and clean on the outside yet filled on the inside with all manner of filth. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, a śramaṇa who is like a basket fashions himself to appear as a śramaṇa and behaves with outer cleanliness and purity, yet on the inside he is completely filled with attachment, aversion, and delusion. Kāśyapa, this is called a śramaṇa who is like a basket.

Kāśyapa, as for the śramaṇa who is like a kuraṇḍaka —

Kāśyapa, as for the kuraṇḍaka flower: consider how this flower is lovely to look upon, yet rough and heavy to the touch, bearing the filth of putrid bees, rank with the smell of corpses, foul with the stench of the root of the baraka plant. The wise and discerning do not touch such a flower, do not pick it up, do not smell it. But those who are childish in nature, not knowing its faults, pick up and smell such a flower.

In just the same way, Kāśyapa, a śramaṇa who is like a kuraṇḍaka may have the outward appearance and form of a śramaṇa, yet he is deeply displeasing. He speaks harsh words. He carries the foul and unpleasant odor of corrupt

moral discipline. His livelihood is debased, his conduct is debased, and his view is debased. The wise and discerning do not rely upon, associate with, or pay homage to such a śramaṇa who is like a kuraṇḍaka; knowing his true character, they abandon him from a distance even greater than far. But those who are childish in nature do rely upon, associate with, and pay homage to such a śramaṇa who is like a kuraṇḍaka — just as a kuraṇḍaka flower held in a child's hand makes the child match its nature entirely. Kāśyapa, this is called a śramaṇa who is like a kuraṇḍaka.

Kāśyapa, as for the śramaṇa who is like a thief — Kāśyapa, consider this: a person who is by nature restless, always covetous, overwhelmed by the grip of attachment, never content with what is his own, setting his hopes upon the wealth of others, aggressive, carrying clubs and weapons and instruments of harm, shameless, without compassion, always possessing a cruel and utterly vicious mind — when such a person enters a hamlet, a village, a city, a town, or a district, he thinks: "Whatever heaps of wealth belong to others, if only they would become mine!" With this thought he wanders here and there in a furtive, prowling manner, looking to seize whatever he can.

In just the same way, Kāśyapa, a śramaṇa who is like a thief is always covetous, overwhelmed by the grip of attachment, never content with what is his own, always hoping for the gains of others. When he enters a hamlet, a village, a city, a town, or a district, he does so for the sake of gain alone and not for the sake of the Dharma. Every aspect of his conduct is displayed in the manner of a thief. He conceals and hides himself, for he thinks: "If other monks were to know that I have broken my moral discipline, it would not be fitting — if it became known, I would be expelled from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra." In constant fear, in constant dread, every aspect of his conduct is deceitful. Thus the gods (devas), nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas come to know of him: "A thief approaches. A thief departs. A thief stands. A thief walks. A thief sits. A thief reclines. A thief receives robes. A thief enters the village. A thief leaves the village. A thief eats. A thief drinks. A thief shaves his head."

Kāśyapa, thus the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas come to know that every aspect of his conduct is unfit and that he is utterly exposed. Knowing this, they give rise to great compassion toward him, and they revile him, speaking ill of him, saying: "Alas, how astonishing — it is wicked monks such as these who will bring the teaching of the Blessed One Śākyamuni to ruin." But toward those who are endowed with moral discipline and endowed with virtue, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas —

and the gandharvas, too, pay them the deepest reverence, saying: "These ones uphold the teaching."

Kāśyapa, a śramaṇa who has gone forth into this teaching and is like a thief — if he cannot produce even a single thought of weariness with saṃsāra or of freedom from attachment, then the attainment of any fruit is, needless to say, entirely out of the question. Kāśyapa, such a one is to be called a thief-like śramaṇa.

Kāśyapa, what then is a śramaṇa who is an empty husk? Kāśyapa, it is like this: among a crop of grain, those seeds that are unripened, shriveled, empty, and mere shells in appearance are called husks. Kāśyapa, in the same way, a śramaṇa who is an empty husk is one who is feeble in spiritual power, seized by māra, overwhelmed by māra, overwhelmed by all the afflictions, robbed by all the afflictions — like one scattered by the wind. Kāśyapa, the name "empty-husk śramaṇa" is a label applied by monks who are immoral and wicked. It is they who have affixed that designation, and I, for my part, have also given that name to such a one.

Kāśyapa, what then is a śramaṇa who is a corrupter? Kāśyapa, it is like this: consider a fine, thriving crop of barley. A blight arises within it, and because that blight resembles the barley in color, in marks, and in shape, the owner of the barley-field forms the perception that all of it is barley. But when the time comes that the healthy barley-shoots have put forth their ears, that blight will no longer give rise to the perception of being barley. Kāśyapa, in the same way, a corrupter-śramaṇa is a monk who sits within the assembly of the Saṅgha, and because he resembles in color and outward marks those who are endowed with moral discipline, endowed with virtue, and who have become worthy fields for giving, the donors and patrons form the perception that he is a śramaṇa and cultivate the perception that he is a worthy recipient of their gifts. Then, if an undiscerning man who is not a śramaṇa claims to be one, who is not a celibate claims to be celibate — one rotten within and oozing with defilements — departs from that assembly, dies, and at the time of death goes to a hell realm, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas who are endowed with divine sight see that he has been born in a hell realm. Having seen this, they give rise to great compassion, saying: "This undiscerning one formerly, wearing the color and form of a śramaṇa, performed evil deeds, and so he has been born in a great hell — just as a blight among barley possesses none of the qualities of barley, so this one too bears no fruit of the qualities of a

śramaṇa." Kāśyapa, such a one is called a corrupter-śramaṇa.

Kāśyapa, what then is a śramaṇa who is a counterfeit? Kāśyapa, it is like this: there is a piece of iron called "great whetstone iron." When it has been thoroughly refined and thoroughly purified, it comes to resemble gold — and yet it is not the equal of gold in worth, in color, in luster when polished, or in weight when measured on a scale. Kāśyapa, in the same way, a counterfeit śramaṇa is a monk who has bathed his body thoroughly, who wears fine and beautiful robes, and who has made all his outer conduct as a śramaṇa perfectly pure — his going and coming, his looking straight ahead, his looking to the right and left, his drawing in and stretching out, his handling of the patchwork robe, the begging bowl, and the outer robe, all performed with apparent vigilance — and yet he is one overcome by attachment, overcome by aversion, overcome by delusion,

overcome by affliction, overcome by gain and honor, and overcome by the seven forms of pride — ordinary pride, great pride, pride greater than pride, the pride of "I," arrogant pride, a little pride, and distorted pride — boiling with affliction, eagerly taking up attendance and service while not eagerly taking up the Dharma, striving to adorn the body yet not striving to adorn himself with moral discipline, eagerly taking up food and clothing while not eagerly taking up the noble Dharma, not seeing transcendent wrongdoing as something to fear, devoted to this life while not devoted to the next, relying on the body's nourishment, on gain, on honor, and on fame rather than relying on what is to be done with respect to the Dharma, stained with various stains, tainted by evil, ardently engaged in the affairs of the household, possessed of a mind equal to that of a householder — rejoicing in joys and suffering in sufferings — and overcome by attachment and anger. All the śramaṇa rites, all the modes of conduct, all the mind and mental factors of such a one incline toward the hells, toward the realms of animal birth, and toward the world of the Lord of Death. He is not equal to the worth, the luster, or the weight on the scale of a śramaṇa. Kāśyapa, this is called a counterfeit śramaṇa.

Kāśyapa, how is it that a monk is one whose luster has been stolen away? Kāśyapa, consider this example: if some man or woman, boy or girl, has had their luster stolen away by a non-human being, they become known as having little vitality; their complexion becomes bad and they become unattractive. In such a case, medicine, secret formulas, or knowledge-mantras cannot help those whose luster has been stolen. In the end, short of death, no other transformation will occur.

Kāśyapa, in the same way, a monk in whom there is no luster of moral discipline, no luster of meditative absorption (samādhi), no luster of wisdom, no luster of liberation, no luster of the knowledge and vision of liberation, no luster of loving-kindness, no luster of compassion, no luster of joy, no luster of equanimity, no luster of generosity, of right restraint, and of certainty, no luster of the virtues of a śramaṇa, no luster of abiding in the noble lineage, no luster of dwelling in the accomplishments of training and the requisites of practice, and no luster of the complete purity of body, speech, and mind — such a one, Kāśyapa, is called a monk whose luster has been stolen away. For one such as this, the medicine compounded by the Tathāgata is of no avail: the medicine of the unattractive for attachment, loving-kindness for aversion, dependent origination for delusion, appropriate attention for the afflictions, delight in solitude away from crowds, dwelling in a hermitage for the sake of abandoning all clinging, the complete purity of body, speech, and mind for the sake of restraint in the three gates, and the medicine of the complete purity of meditative absorption compounded by the Tathāgata for the sake of making the mind workable — none of these medicines are of any avail for such a one. After death, he will go straight to the hells; in the end, no other transformation will occur.

And those who take up the medicine that transcends the world — the knowledge of the aggregates, the knowledge of the elements, the knowledge of the sense sources, the knowledge of dependent origination, emptiness, signlessness,

and wishlessness as medicine that transcends the world — even these medicines are of no avail for such a one. After death, he too will go straight to the hells; in the end, no other transformation will occur.

When this teaching had been set forth, five hundred monks who were practitioners of Yogācāra, reflecting that to live as householders with faith while their moral discipline was not yet completely pure would be improper, fell away from the training and returned home to lay life. At this, certain other monks said: "It is truly not good that these great and self-possessed practitioners of Yogācāra have fallen away from the teaching." And they mocked them.

The Blessed One then addressed those monks with these words: "Monks, do not say that it is truly not good that these great and self-possessed ones have fallen away from the teaching in this manner. Why is that? Monks, living as a

householder without delight in the monastic life is the proper course for those with faith. Monks, those who are rich in faith and devotion, and who are possessed of remorse — hearing this teaching and thinking that to enjoy what has been given through faith while their moral discipline is not yet completely pure would be improper, they fell away from the training. Kāśyapa, I prophesy: these monks, passing from this life, will be reborn among the gods of the Tuṣita heaven, and they will be counted among the first-assembled hearers of the Tathāgata Maitreya."

This concludes the third chapter, the chapter on the monk who is like an outcaste ascetic.

The second fascicle, being the last.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what manner of monks is it proper for a monk to preside over?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kāśyapa, I permit a monk to preside over two kinds of monks. Which two? First, a monk who is completely pure, who regards blame in the next world with fear, who relies on the ripening of karma, who is endowed with shame and with remorse; and second, one whose defilements are exhausted, who has become an arhat. Kāśyapa, I permit a monk who has not fallen away to preside over these two kinds of monks.

"Why is this? Kāśyapa, in this well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, monks have gone forth from many different classes and social backgrounds; they have various mental dispositions; they dwell in various practices of renunciation. Some delight in the peaceful resting places of forest hermitages. Some live as alms-collectors. Some dwell at the edges of settlements. Some maintain a completely pure livelihood. Some apply themselves diligently to extensive learning. Some are Dharma speakers. Some uphold the Vinaya. Some uphold the Mātṛkā texts. Some enter villages, towns, market-towns, districts, and royal enclosures to teach the Dharma, because guarding the mental conduct of other sentient beings is difficult. Kāśyapa, in all of this, a presiding monk must satisfy the minds of the entire monastic Saṅgha.

"Kāśyapa, a presiding monk must not assign to monks the remote boundary lodgings belonging to forest-dwelling monks. A presiding monk must protect those forest-dwelling monks: he must not summon them at an improper time, and he must not send them away at an improper time.

"Kāśyapa, if a communal Saṅgha task arises that happens to fall as a turn of training-duty upon a forest-dwelling monk, that presiding monk should either perform that task himself, or appoint another monk and have him carry it out — but he must not cause harm to the forest-dwelling monk.

"Kāśyapa, with regard to a monk who is a practitioner of alms-collection, a presiding monk must share with him a portion of the gathered food. Kāśyapa, with regard to monks who are practitioners of Yogācāra, a presiding monk must provide them with suitable provisions, medicine for the sick,

and all necessary requisites. In whatever place a monk who is a practitioner of Yogācāra is staying, the presiding monk of that place must not raise a loud commotion or harsh sounds there, nor allow others to do so. The presiding monk must protect that monk who is a practitioner of Yogācāra and also provide him with bedding. He must give him collected food, whatever comes to hand in writing, and food and provisions suitable for a place of Yogācāra practice. Toward that monk, the presiding monk should give rise to a perception of deep longing, thinking: "This monk abides here in order to rely upon the teaching of the Tathāgata; therefore I shall abundantly provide him with all requisites befitting him."

Kāśyapa, with regard to those monks who are devoted to extensive learning, the presiding monk should ask them to recite scripture, to chant, to memorize, saying with encouragement: "I am here to serve you; the more you become learned, the more you will adorn the Saṅgha of monks. Adorn it through your sitting and your teaching. Let your own wisdom become supreme." The presiding monk must not send those monks away at an improper time, nor assign them to tasks. The presiding monk must protect those monks who are devoted to extensive learning.

Kāśyapa, with regard to monks who are Dharma-speakers, the presiding monk must not assign them to tasks. He should send them out into villages, towns, districts, surrounding regions, and the precincts of royal palaces to teach the Dharma. He should appoint monks to listen to the Dharma. He should purify the assembly circle of the retinue and seat them in the circle for the sake of the Dharma-talk that will arise. If any monks cause harm to a Dharma-speaking monk, the presiding monk should turn them back. The presiding monk should always go out to receive the Dharma-speaking monk and offer abundant words of "Well done!"

Kāśyapa, with regard to monks who are holders of the Vinaya and holders of the Mātṛkā, the presiding monk should go to them and ask in full: "How may I serve the Dharma without wound or loss to myself, and without transgression?" Then those monks who are holders of the Vinaya and holders of the Mātṛkā, having understood the intention of the presiding monk, should instruct him in what his activities are, how they arise, and how they are to be carried out. The presiding monk should give rise toward those monks who are holders of the Vinaya and holders of the Mātṛkā to deep longing, to faith, to reverence, and to following them.

Whatever gain belongs to the Saṅgha, the presiding monk must at regular intervals distribute it to the monastic Saṅgha; he must not accumulate and conceal the Saṅgha's gain, but must give it just as it is received — give it without being prompted, give it without causing harm. He must not act out of desire, aversion, delusion, or fear. He must rely on the monastic Saṅgha and not rely on the lay side. He must rely on the affairs of the Saṅgha and not on his own affairs. He must not give rise to the perception of exercising authority over any material thing; even the smallest matter is to be done in accordance with the Saṅgha's deliberation, and not at his own pleasure. Whatever belongs to the Saṅgha — or to the Saṅgha of the four directions —

— whatever articles of a stūpa there may be, all of these are likewise to be left just as they are. They must not be mixed with the gain of the Saṅgha or with the gain of the Saṅgha of the four directions. Equally, the gain of the Saṅgha of the four directions must not be mixed with the gain of the local Saṅgha. The gain of the local Saṅgha and of the Saṅgha of the four directions must not be mixed with that of the stūpa. And the gain of the stūpa must not be mixed with the gain of the local Saṅgha or the Saṅgha of the four directions.

If the Saṅgha of the four directions should fall into hardship and the gain of the local Saṅgha has grown large, then the steward monk shall convene the assembly of monks, reach a consensus, and from that gain of the Saṅgha transfer some to the Saṅgha of the four directions.

If a Tathāgata stūpa should fall into ruin and the gain of both the local Saṅgha and the Saṅgha of the four directions has grown large, then the steward monk shall convene the entire assembly of monks, reach a consensus, and declare as follows: "This Tathāgata stūpa has fallen into ruin, and the gain of the local Saṅgha and of the Saṅgha of the four directions has grown large. If the venerable ones have no objection, have faith, are patient, and give their

consent, then I shall take a small portion of this gain of the local Saṅgha and of the Saṅgha of the four directions and repair this Tathāgata stūpa." If the Saṅgha consents, the steward monk shall do exactly that. If the Saṅgha does not consent, the steward monk shall seek the support of donors and benefactors and restore the Tathāgata stūpa.

Kāśyapa, however plentiful the gain of the stūpa may become, the steward monk must not transfer it to the local Saṅgha or to the Saṅgha of the four directions. Why is that? Because many who have faith and are pure of heart have offered it to the stūpa — even so little as a single fringe of cotton cloth — and that offering is a shrine for the world together with its gods. Precious things, and things said to be precious, need hardly even be mentioned. Whatever cloth has been offered to the stūpa: even if wind, sun, and rain have worn it thin, that cloth offered to the stūpa must not be converted into goods or their cash equivalent. Why? Because the stūpa is without the slightest price, and the stūpa has no needs whatsoever.

Kāśyapa, the steward monk must conduct himself with such complete purity that he does not diminish the gain of the Three Jewels. He must be content with his own gain. He must not form the perception of ownership with regard to things consecrated by the Three Jewels.

Kāśyapa, if a certain steward monk, acting with a mind of intense hatred, becomes angry with those who observe moral discipline, who possess virtue, and who are fields of generosity, and goes on to exercise authority over them and issue arbitrary commands — by that non-virtuous action he will go to hell. And if he returns to the human world, he will be reduced to the condition of a servant doing another's work, and will meet with blows from fists, from a rod, and from weapons wielded in anger.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a steward monk who transgresses the affairs of the Saṅgha and, at his own pleasure, exercises authority over monks, issues commands, imposes punishments, instils fear, threatens, dispatches them at untimely hours,

dispatches them at untimely hours — by that non-virtuous action he will be born in a hell for short-lived beings called Many Iron Spikes. Born there, a thousand iron spikes will be driven into his body, and those spikes will blaze, burn fiercely, flare up completely, and burst into flame on every side.

And whoever, having dispatched monks at untimely hours, has also reviled and spoken harmful words of speech against those who possess moral

discipline, who possess good qualities, and who are fields of generosity — that person, being born there, will find that the span of his tongue extends to a hundred leagues, and upon that tongue a thousand iron spikes will rain down and blaze, burn fiercely, blaze on every side, flare up completely on every side, and be utterly consumed in fire. Why is this? Because he reviled those worthy ones and spoke harmful words against them.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a steward monk in whose charge the gains of the Saṅgha have been gathered and deposited, who does not distribute them at the proper times, but instead beats and torments and gives grudgingly — giving to some and not to others, giving on one occasion and not on another — by that non-virtuous action he will be born among the hungry ghosts in a realm called Filth-Given-at-Dusk. Born there, when another hungry ghost takes food and shows it to him, he will gaze upon that food with both eyes unblinking, experiencing the suffering of being oppressed by hunger and thirst, and yet for a thousand years he will not obtain so much as a morsel of that food. And even if, once in every hundred occasions, he does obtain it, it will turn into vomit, pus, and blood. Why is this? Because he did not satisfy those who possess moral discipline, who possess good qualities, and who are fields of generosity, and because he was insatiable with respect to his own gains.

Kāśyapa, as for a steward monk who misappropriates what belongs to the Saṅgha, or to the Saṅgha of the four directions, or to a stūpa — the karmic maturation of that deed is something I could not fully recount even were I to count out the kalpas.

Kāśyapa, as for a steward monk who, upon hearing about such faults and dangers as these, responds with anger, harsh speech, malicious intent, or indignation — I declare that such a person is beyond correction.

Therefore, Kāśyapa, having heard such teachings of the sacred Dharma as these, a steward monk must purify body, speech, and mind completely, and must guard both himself and others.

Kāśyapa, it would be easier for a steward monk to eat his own flesh than to make full use of an alms bowl, a Dharma robe, almsfood, medicine for the sick, or requisites that have been consecrated by the Three Jewels.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, you have declared the Dharma of the lax for those who are lax, and the Dharma of the conscientious for those who are conscientious."

This concludes the fourth chapter, the chapter on stewards.

The Blessed One then spoke. Among monks who dwell in forest hermitages, those who claim the title of forest-dwelling monk — Blessed One, what constitutes a monk who is a forest-dweller? What constitutes a monk who is an alms-round practitioner? What constitutes a monk who is a rag-robe wearer?

When this was said, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Mahākāśyapa: Kāśyapa, a forest-dwelling monk should take up lodging in a hermitage, in a forest dwelling, or at the foot of a tree at the edge of a forest. He should dwell in such a hermitage — at its very perimeter — where there are no thieves, no shepherds, no cowherds, no venomous snakes, few wild animals and birds, few insects and mosquitoes, little noise, and little commotion.

While dwelling in such a forest hermitage, he should cultivate eight mental engagements. What are the eight? Not attending to the body;

not attending to life; not attending to gain and honor; not attending to any form of socializing; accepting, like a wild animal dying in the forest, that one will die in the hermitage; dwelling in the hermitage having thoroughly taken up the qualities of a hermitage; living by a livelihood of Dharma and not by wrong livelihood; and living by a livelihood free from material goods and afflictions. Having aroused these eight mental engagements, one should dwell in a forest hermitage.

While dwelling in that forest hermitage, one should arouse eight forms of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. What are the eight? Loving-kindness that brings benefit; loving-kindness that brings happiness; loving-kindness free from harm; genuine loving-kindness; loving-kindness without discrimination; loving-kindness of calm abiding; loving-kindness that is firmly intent on the Dharma; and loving-kindness of completely purified intention. One should arouse these eight forms of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings.

While dwelling in that forest hermitage, one should arouse this thought: I have come here from a long journey, alone, without a companion — there is no friend at all to encourage me toward what is good or to warn me away from what is wrong. Yet there are gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, and the awakened Blessed Ones who know the intentions of my mind. If, while I am dwelling in this forest hermitage, I come under the power of a non-virtuous mind, I will come under their power. I have come from a long journey and am

alone — I have no support, nothing that is mine, nothing to cling to. If I were to think conceptually with thoughts of desire, to think conceptually with thoughts of ill will, to think conceptually with thoughts of harm, or to think conceptually with other non-virtuous thoughts, then I would become indistinguishable from those beings who cling to self and delight in gathering together. I would be deceiving the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas, and I would be displeasing the awakened Blessed Ones. Therefore, no matter what, I shall act in such a way that the gods will not mock me and the awakened Blessed Ones will be pleased. One should arouse the mind in just this way.

While dwelling in that forest hermitage, one should be restrained by the vow of individual liberation (Skt. prātimokṣa) and guard the aggregate of moral discipline with great care. One should maintain complete purity of body, speech, and mind; be free from pretense; be free from flattery; have a completely pure livelihood; make the mind of meditative absorption manifest; rely on the Dharma as one has heard it; attend to it properly; be accomplished and disenchanting; be free from attachment; incline toward cessation and nirvāṇa; be afraid of saṃsāra; understand the aggregates to be like executioners that strike back; quickly perceive the four elements as a virulent poison; regard the six sense bases (Skt. āyatana) as like an empty village; be skilled in entering into dependent origination; thoroughly abandon the views of permanence and annihilation; conduct oneself with the understanding that there is no sentient being, no life-force, no living soul, and no person; be devoted to emptiness; make the signless one's domain; cultivate a mind free from aspiration; be ever possessed of a mind that sees the three realms as subject to destruction; always apply diligence as if one's head and garments were on fire; not abandon that effort; individually examine the faults of the body precisely as they are; observe the arising and ceasing of mind;

to be zealous in fully understanding suffering; to have abandoned craving, the origin of all that arises; to have entered upon the direct realization of cessation; to be diligent in the yoga of cultivating the path; to be thoroughly established in the close application of mindfulness to outer objects of experience; to be free of unwholesome phenomena; to be oriented toward wholesome phenomena; to be firmly established in right abandonment; to have brought forth the bases of miraculous power (ṛddhipāda); to be endowed with the five faculties; to be endowed with the force of the five powers; to be concentrated in the seven branches of awakening; to be zealous in the noble eightfold path; to abide in calm abiding; and to look with insight.

Kāśyapa, having donned this kind of armor, one should not sleep during the first or last watch of the night but should be diligent in yoga, and should habitually dwell in that wilderness abode, dwelling there in a distinctly superior manner. While dwelling in that wilderness abode, one should not be diligent in adorning the body. One should not be diligent in adorning one's bedding and furnishings. One should not be diligent in adorning one's Dharma robes. One should gather dry, old grass and spread it well on one's walking and sitting place, and there one should sit — content with one's own robe, not polluted by material possessions, dwelling in that wilderness abode in a manner that suffices for oneself, for the Saṅgha, and for the Saṅgha of the four directions alike, without being compromised.

Kāśyapa, when a monk who dwells in the wilderness, in order to sustain his body and in reliance upon the noble path, enters a village, a town, or a hamlet for the purpose of gathering alms, he should set out from that wilderness abode with the following state of mind: if he does not receive anything, he should not be utterly dejected; if he does receive something, he should not generate delight. He should keep in mind the karmic ripening of actions. He should rely upon merit. Meditating with the Tathāgata in mind, he should then enter the village, the town, or the hamlet for the purpose of gathering alms. While going on alms rounds in the village, town, or hamlet, he should conduct his alms round having donned the armor of the Dharma. And what is that armor of the Dharma? When with the eye he sees agreeable forms, he should not become attached to them. When he sees disagreeable forms, he should not become angry at them. Likewise, with pleasant and unpleasant sounds, smells, tastes, and tactile objects, he should not generate attachment or anger. He should keep the sense faculties thoroughly restrained, the eyes undistracted, the gaze directed no further than the length of a yoke, be tamed, be possessed of a watchful mind, not cast aside what was previously held in mind, and conduct his alms round with a mental continuum unpolluted by material concerns. He should collect alms in order, going to the very end. Toward whatever place alms are received, he should not generate attachment. Toward whatever place alms are not received, he should not generate anger. If, having begun at the first house and going through ten houses, he does not receive alms even at the eleventh, he should not be utterly dejected. Rather, he should generate the perception: these brahmins and householders have many affairs, and there is no certainty that they will give to me — that they even think of me at all would be remarkable, let alone that they give alms.

With that perception, he should go on alms rounds without becoming utterly dejected. Toward whatever sentient beings appear before his eyes — men, women, boys, girls, or even those born in the animal realm — he should arouse a mind of loving-kindness and compassion. By all means, toward whatever sentient beings appear before his eyes, or

those who give alms — may they go to the higher realms. That is how it should be done; that is how diligence should be applied.

Having collected alms, whether poor or good, he should survey all four directions throughout that village, town, or settlement, thinking: who are the destitute sentient beings here to whom I should give a share of these alms? If he sees a destitute sentient being, he should share a portion of those alms with them. If he sees no destitute sentient being, he should generate this thought: as for those sentient beings who have not appeared before my eyes and remain unseen — to them I give the first portion of these alms; after giving it, may those who receive it use it fully. Having generated that intention, he should carry the alms and return to his dwelling in the forest hermitage. He should wash his bowl and his hands, and with the fine conduct of a contemplative (Skt. śramaṇa) and the good conduct of one endowed with contentment, he should consecrate the meal. Then, sitting cross-legged, he should eat those alms. He should eat without attachment, without ill-will, without craving, without clinging. Having eaten, he should think: in this body there are eighty thousand kinds of small organisms; by the power of this food, may they abide in ease. Now I gather them through material benefit; once I attain awakening, I will gather them through the Dharma — and he should generate that resolve.

If his alms were poor, he should generate this thought: poor food will make my body light, I will be able to endure renunciation, my excretions will be few, what is given to me out of faith will be meager, my body and mind will be light, I will be less drowsy and sleepy, and my mind will not be bound all around by thoughts of attachment — he should cultivate thoughts such as these in his mind.

If, on the other hand, he has obtained abundant alms, he should eat just enough of them. And it is indeed his nature to discard the remainder: he should scatter the leftover alms on any flat stone and generate the thought: to whatever predatory animals or flocks of birds desire material food — may those who receive it eat of this.

Having eaten and washed his bowl and hands, he should dwell in dependence on the hermitage. He should not abandon those very mental practices he engaged in before.

Kāśyapa, if a forest-dwelling monk who has not yet attained the fruit should be approached among ordinary people by fierce snakes and predatory animals, he should not be afraid or frightened of them. Rather, he should generate this thought: from the very beginning I have abandoned body and life and come to dwell in this hermitage; therefore I must not be afraid of these, I must not be frightened, I must arouse a mind of loving-kindness, I must abandon aversion, I must relinquish fear — and he should generate that resolve.

If, having done so, those snakes and predatory animals still kill and eat him, he should think: I am unable to satisfy these animals with mere material things; but by eating my flesh they will abide in contact with ease, and I will have extracted what is essential from this body that holds nothing essential — truly, I have found a good finding. Now I gather them through material benefit; once I attain awakening, I will gather them through the Dharma — and he should generate that resolve.

Kāśyapa, a monk dwelling in a hermitage should dwell there in just this way, without regard for body or life. If, while dwelling in that hermitage, a non-human being (Skt. *amanuṣya*) should come — whether beautiful in appearance or ugly — he should not feel attached to it, nor should he be angered by it.

If gods who have seen former buddhas come to the hermitage monk's dwelling and ask him questions, that hermitage monk should teach those gods the Dharma according to what he has heard. If those gods ask deep and probing questions, and the hermitage monk is unable to answer, he should not be arrogant about it, nor should he show contempt toward what he has not yet trained in. Rather, he should accept a scriptural transmission from the Buddha's teaching and make the effort to understand those aspects of the Dharma he has not yet understood — and when he has understood them, he should then answer all the questions that were asked. He should say: "I am a student of the Dharma; please feel confident to ask." Kāśyapa, the hermitage monk should engage with those gods in just that way.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a monk dwelling in a hermitage should cultivate very deeply the perception of the hermitage. With regard to this body: it is like grass, like wood, like a wall, like a mound of earth, like a mirage — it has no

owner, it is not mine, there is nothing to be grasped in it. In this body there is no self, no sentient being, no life-force, no person — these phenomena arise through dependent origination, produced from causes and conditions, arisen from the coming together of operative factors, and everything that has become the view of "mine" will entirely be pacified. In just this way one should engage in proper individual analysis.

One should also keep in mind, without interruption, the Dharma of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness. That is how one should train.

Dwelling in that hermitage, one should observe how the grasses, creeping plants, medicines, and forests there arise and how they disintegrate, and how these outer phenomena have no owner, are not mine, have nothing to be grasped in them — how they are without motion and without agency, arising and perishing while empty, and no one brings them into being or causes them to cease. Taking hold of that sign, one should reflect: in the same way this body too is like grass, like a wall, like wood, like a mound of earth, like a mirage — without an owner, not mine, without anything to be grasped, without motion, without agency, arising from the coming together of causes and conditions, and not arising when causes and conditions are incomplete. Taking hold of the sign, one should understand: in this body, in the ultimate sense, there is absolutely nothing that has the nature of arising or ceasing.

Kāśyapa, a hermitage monk should dwell in the hermitage with just such a practice grounded in Dharma as his commitment. One who dwells in such Dharma will quickly become distinguished, whether on the vehicle of the śrāvakas, the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, or the vehicle of the bodhisattvas. If one is on the vehicle of the śrāvakas, one will swiftly attain the fruit. Even if one should be obscured by karmic obscurations and fail to attain the fruit, one will not pass through more than two or three Tathāgatas before the mind is fully liberated from the defilements. If one is on the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, one will swiftly attain solitary awakening. If one is on the vehicle of the bodhisattvas, one will attain in this very lifetime the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena, and one will see the buddhas without obstruction. And having seen the buddhas without obstruction, one will swiftly and fully awaken to the supreme, perfect, and complete awakening.

When this chapter on the hermitage monk was taught, five hundred monks were fully liberated from the defilements without clinging. This concludes the fifth chapter, the chapter on the hermitage monk.

Kāśyapa, how then is a monk one who practices the collection of alms? Kāśyapa, a monk who practices the collection of alms abides in this way: "I sustain myself on alms-food,

and I shall train myself to abide in my former aspiration and vow, having gone forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya." A monk who practices the collection of alms and who possesses superior intention shall train in the following: being without greed; being without pretense; being without flattery; having no thought whatsoever of inviting guests; not misappropriating the Saṅgha's material gains; and remaining firm in his commitment.

He shall not, in any and all circumstances, generate any perception of savoring the taste of fine foods. He shall train himself thus: "I am like an outcaste; I shall purify body and mind, but I shall not purify the body through food." Why is this? However much fine food one eats, it all ends as pus at the last, is disagreeable at the last, and is foul-smelling at the last. Therefore I shall train myself thus: "I shall not desire what is fine."

With a mind that has resolved itself in this way, when entering a village, a town, or a settlement for the purpose of collecting alms, one shall go in orderly sequence. And one shall generate this thought: "May it not be that a man will give me alms but not a woman, or that a woman will give me alms but not a man, or that a boy will give me alms but not a girl, or that a girl will give me alms but not a boy. May it not be that I obtain what is fine and not what is poor. May it not be that, having paid honor to someone, I receive a gift in return for that honor but not otherwise. May it not be that I obtain it easily and with difficulty not. May it not be that men and women, boys and girls, come to receive me, and that I am invited to stay on the spot, or that I obtain an exceptionally rich gain, or that I obtain fine food of many flavors while obtaining nothing like the coarse food of the poor." One shall not generate any of these unwholesome mental engagements.

And one shall also don this armor: not being wholly discouraged whether or not one obtains a gift, and not generating a perception of bad or good — this is the very nature of the Dharma for monks who practice the collection of alms. Why is this? The majority of sentient beings are greedy for taste, and having performed sinful actions for the sake of food, they are born in the hells. Those who are content, who are without greed, who are unattached and not greedy for taste, who know contentment with regard to the faculty of the tongue, who sustain themselves on however little poor food there may be — these, when

they pass on and have met the time of death, will be reborn in the higher realms; they will go to a happy destiny among gods and humans; and being born as gods, they will eat ambrosia.

Therefore, Kāśyapa, a monk who practices the collection of alms, having turned away craving for taste and with a mind firmly resolved, shall not be discouraged even if he eats food that is seven days old and left over. Why is this? Because he thinks: "I eat food for the purpose of sustaining the body and accumulating the provisions of the noble path."

Kāśyapa, what comes into the bowl of a monk who practices the collection of alms, what falls into the bowl — if it accords with the Dharma, if it is a Dharma-obtained gain — he shall eat it in common together with monks who live the holy life in a similar manner.

Kāśyapa, if a monk who practices the collection of alms falls ill, has no attendant, and is unable to go out for alms, he shall think: "I am without a companion; I am alone and without a second; I have gone forth; my companion is the Dharma; I rely upon the Dharma;

I am unwell and suffering, gravely ill. Yet the Tathāgata has spoken the medicine of the Dharma, and just as I have heard it, I shall rightly examine those teachings." He shall arouse this resolve in his mind.

Kāśyapa, the correct engagement with those things in the proper manner — the thorough and accurate discernment of this body — is what is called right application. When one who has thus entered upon the right path thoroughly and accurately discerns the faults of this body, one's mind becomes one-pointed, endowed with mindfulness and with vigilance. The ground from which the first meditative concentration (dhyāna) is produced will come to be present. Having attained that meditative concentration, when one wishes to dwell in the bliss of meditative concentration, one abides sustained by the nourishment of that bliss of meditative concentration for one day, or two days, or three days, or up to seven days. If, while having thus entered upon the practice of yoga, one is unable to produce meditative concentration, then for a monk who practices the holy life with diligence and who abides in the Dharma, gods endowed with higher knowledge, nāgas, and yakṣas will bring food. Why is this so? Because this is in accord with the cause of those who practice yoga, and because gains protected by those gods will thereby come to them.

Kāśyapa, if clouds gather and rain falls, and the time comes when a monk who practices the collection of alms cannot go out for alms, he shall rest in the

portion of loving-kindness's nourishment, abiding in the contemplation and mental application of the Dharma. Should two or three days pass without food, let him think: there exist hungry ghosts (pretas) who have committed the offenses that bring them into the realm of Yama, lord of the dead, and who for a hundred years cannot find so much as a single drop of spittle to eat. Therefore, abiding properly in the contemplation of the Dharma, I shall not allow my body to become dispirited, nor my mind to become faint. Whatever discomfort hunger and thirst may bring, I shall disregard it. I shall arouse the perception: I will apply unceasing diligent effort to the cultivation of the noble path.

Kāśyapa, a monk who practices the collection of alms shall not become familiar with households, nor familiar with men, nor familiar with women, nor familiar with boys, nor familiar with girls. At whatever household a clean offering of alms food is being prepared, he shall sit down there and speak words of Dharma until the preparation of the clean offering is complete. Then, having received that alms food, he shall rise from his seat and depart.

Kāśyapa, a monk who practices the collection of alms shall not be resentful, shall not be flattering, and shall not feign good conduct. What is resentment? It is this: speaking such words to others as — "My alms food is poor," "My alms food is coarse," "Formerly I ate my fill of better than this," "My alms food has been shared with many people," "I ate little; being unsatisfied, my body has become faint" — any such signs of resentment, whatever form they take, this is called distorting the mind's proper conduct. A monk who practices the collection of alms shall do none of these things. Whatever comes into the bowl — whether poor or good, little or much, clean or unclean — he shall eat it. He shall eat the alms food free from torment, with a purified intention, with much resolve regarding the Dharma, for the sake of sustaining the body and of supporting the noble path.

Kāśyapa, if a monk who practices the collection of alms goes out for alms in a village, a town, or a settlement and finds nothing, and returns just as though his bowl had been washed clean, he shall call the Tathāgata to mind — the Tathāgata, resplendent with the glory of merit, who renounced a wheel-turning king's sovereignty and went forth, and who is worshipped with offerings by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and fragrance-eaters (gandharvas) —

who has abandoned all non-virtuous phenomena, who is endowed with all virtuous phenomena, and who is utterly free from all afflictions — and if even

he, when he went into a village to gather alms, returned just as though his bowl had been washed clean, then how should someone like me, who has little merit and has not yet cultivated roots of virtue, become dejected merely because I have come back as though my bowl were washed clean? Why so? Because it is on account of not having cultivated roots of virtue that one fails to obtain fine food. If it is through the deeds of Māra or through Māra's blessing that those brahmins and householders do not give me alms, then how much more should I think: "Let me accomplish in this way the complete passing beyond the four Māras and the complete freedom from all afflictions." One who dwells thus in my earnest training will not be found vulnerable by Māra and the gods of Māra's host. Kāśyapa, a monk who practices the collection of alms shall in this way completely purify the lineage of the noble ones.

This is the sixth chapter, on the practice of collecting alms.

Kāśyapa, with what attitude should a monk who practices the collection of rag-robes gather those rag-robes? He should do so with a sense of shame and conscientiousness, adopting a serviceable attitude — but not with an attitude of striving to adorn himself with robes. It is for the sake of full protection against wind, sun, insects, flies, and poisonous snakes — and not for the sake of beautifying the body. One who abides earnestly in the Tathāgata's scriptures takes no delight in fine, clean cloth. Taking a rag-robe from a pile of discarded rags, he shall arouse two perceptions: the perception of contentment and the perception of being easy to satisfy. Furthermore, he shall arouse two more perceptions: the perception of being free from pride and the perception of dwelling in the lineage of the noble ones. And further still, he shall arouse two more perceptions: the perception of the body being clothed and the perception of the mind being pure.

Kāśyapa, if a monk who practices the collection of rag-robes, upon taking a rag-robe from a pile of discarded rags, fears that former acquaintances, former companions in conversation, or those who speak of his arrival might see him and censure him, and on that account does not take the rag-robe — Kāśyapa, I declare that such a monk's practice of collecting rag-robes is not completely pure. Why so? Because a monk who practices the collection of rag-robes must take up rag-robes with a vajra-like mind, and with a vajra-like mind take them up without hesitation. Having taken such a rag-robe, he shall wash it thoroughly until it is exceedingly clean and free of stain, then seek dye, improve its color, sew it into a patched Dharma-robe, and press it smooth.

Thereafter, that it may not deteriorate, he shall press it well, fit it well, stitch it firmly, and wear it.

Kāśyapa, a monk who practices the collection of rag-robles shall wear those rag-robles on his body while dwelling with attention fixed on the unattractive, for the sake of appeasing attachment. He shall wear those rag-robles on his body with a mind of loving-kindness, for the sake of appeasing aversion. He shall wear those rag-robles on his body while abiding in dependent origination, for the sake of appeasing delusion. He shall wear those rag-robles on his body while engaging in appropriate mental attention, for the sake of abandoning all afflictions. He shall wear those rag-robles on his body with the sense faculties well restrained, for the sake of fully knowing the six sense bases. He shall wear those rag-robles on his body free from pretense,

free from flattery, he shall wear those rag-robles on his body.

Kāśyapa, why are they called rag-robles? Kāśyapa, consider: toward a discarded rag, no one gives rise to desire, no one gives rise to attachment, and no one takes it up for themselves — a rag is something that has been thrown away. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, one who wears rag-robles is like a rag: there is no sense of "mine," no grasping, easy to sustain, frugal, needing to ask nothing of others, needing to look to no one else's face, not dependent on others, cast off like a rag. That is why rag-robles are called rag-robles.

This is the lineage of sages. This is the pure lineage of the noble ones. This is the dwelling place of the noble lineage. This is the support for the qualities of what has been trained. This is the guardian of the entire aggregate of moral discipline. This is the gateway to the aggregate of meditative absorption. This is the basis of the aggregate of wisdom. This is the arising of the aggregate of liberation. This is the conformity with the aggregate of the wisdom that sees liberation. Kāśyapa, rag-robles thus have many qualities — they are without obstruction, without occasion for hindrance, without cover — and one becomes stainless and bears what is worthy of bearing.

Kāśyapa, a monk who wears rag-robles and is content with rag-robe garments — even the gods will rejoice in him. Kāśyapa, at such a time and in such an age as this, when a monk who wears rag-robles bears a poor Dharma robe and has entered into the bliss of meditative absorption, even Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, and the world-protecting gods will join their palms, touch his feet with their heads, and prostrate to him — how much more so will other gods bow down. Kāśyapa, as for monks who are devoted to fine garments but

not devoted to yoga, who make much of bodily ornament, who practice outward cleanliness yet are inwardly filled with the stain of attachment, aversion, and delusion — Kāśyapa, however fine the garments such monks wear, they are not a form that the gods delight in. Why is that? The gods know the minds and mental factors of those who are devoted to adorning the body. Knowing this, they keep such monks at a distance and utterly abandon them.

Kāśyapa, a novice who has gone forth soiled by impurity, taking up rag-robles, received alms, and gone to a cool lake. When he arrived there, the gods dwelling in that supreme lake went out to meet him from afar, bowed their heads to his feet in homage, and those gods who practice cleanliness, taking those rag-robles soiled by impurity, washed them themselves until they were stainless, and then sprinkled the wash-water, which had become defiled, on their own bodies. Knowing that the novice had fully taken up the qualities of discipline and had entered into meditative absorption, the gods of that lake bowed down with five limbs touching the ground.

Now consider the wanderer called Suprabha: he put on clean clothes, received alms, and went to that cool lake. The gods dwelling in that lake, within a distance of just one league all around, trembled and gave him warning: "If you eat food here in this supreme lake and then discard what remains, you will defile this supreme lake." Kāśyapa, observe the distinction between one who cultivates the qualities of the noble Dharma and one who is merely a going-forth: the gods sprinkled the defiled wash-water of the rag-robles on their own bodies, while they would not even allow the wanderer Suprabha to pass through.

Kāśyapa, therefore a monk who wears rag-robles, desiring such Dharma qualities as these without becoming faint-hearted, dwelling in the noble lineage, with a perception of the stūpa,

with a perception of the Teacher, and with a perception of having no possessions and no clinging ownership, one should wear rag-robles on the body. For it is the mind that purifies the body, not the body that purifies the mind. Therefore one should purify the mind rather than the body, for purity through the body is not true purity. One should reflect with certainty in the mind: "Purity of mind is what the Blessed One has taught to be the holy life in his teaching."

Kāśyapa, this is how a monk who wears rag-robles should train in accordance with you and me. Kāśyapa, such a time as this, and a teaching such as this, do

exist. Kāśyapa, you, who wear inferior Dharma robes and are content with inferior, worn Dharma robes — wherever you lay aside your patched Dharma robe on a stool or seat, and then walk in the walking-meditation place wearing your upper robe, many hundreds and thousands of gods will come there and bow down to that patched Dharma robe of yours, saying: "This is the Dharma robe worn by a body imbued with moral discipline, meditative absorption, and wisdom." Kāśyapa, see — if they bow down even to the Dharma robe, what need is there to speak of bowing down to the body itself? Kāśyapa, wishing that the monks who train under me would accomplish the same, I renounced the sovereignty of a wheel-turning king and went forth. I gave up fine Kāśika fabric, Dukūla linen, Kautamba cloth, and robes of fine quality, and out of delight in the noble lineage, I wore robes of hempen cloth on my body. Kāśyapa, I took your inferior cloth robe from you and gave you hempen cloth in return, and all of that was out of affection for you yourself — not out of attachment, not for the adornment of the body. Kāśyapa, there are some foolish persons in this matter who do not train in accordance with you and me, who are overcome by the moisture of greed and attachment: they accumulate Dharma robes, they accumulate bowls, they accumulate worldly goods, they store away candles, gold, jewels, and grain, they keep near to them cattle, sheep, elephants, pigs, donkeys, horses, draught animals, and carts. Those who engage in all the activities of householders — Kāśyapa, they may indeed be distinguished from lay householders, but as for those foolish ones who have overstepped the bounds of the going-forth, there is nothing whatsoever to distinguish them. Kāśyapa, those who are distinguished from lay householders are those who are not śramaṇas yet claim to be śramaṇas, those who do not lead the holy life yet claim to lead the holy life, those who wear the saffron robe and yet are busy with many activities, who have smeared themselves with various kinds of deceit, who are keen on food and clothing — it is from these that lay householders, recognizing that they wear the saffron robe, generate devotion and respect, gather them in with Dharma robes and alms-food, speak respectfully to them, bow down, and rise to receive them. Kāśyapa, this is the distinction that exists for those lay householders, but for those who have gone forth it is absent. Why is that? Because those householders are not striving after grasping, and they accumulate nothing whatsoever. Kāśyapa, at that time, in that age, most monks will have many bowls and many Dharma robes, many utensils and many acquisitions, and they will be shown deference, treated with reverence, depicted in images, and venerated with offerings. Why is that? Because they give and give back at

every opportunity and grasp at things in accordance with their activities. As for those monks who possess moral discipline, who are of virtuous character, who strive diligently to exhaust all defilements (āsravas), who are disenchanted, who exert themselves as though their head and robe were on fire, who engage in few affairs and do little —

— who strive for their own liberation, who have wholly abandoned the habit of socializing — to the dwelling places of those monks, in that age and at that time, no one whatsoever will come. No one will rely upon them, attend upon them, or pay them reverence. Why is that? Because householders by nature are attached to this present life and do not take care for future lives. They think to themselves: "If those monks are of no use to our livelihood, why should we rely on them, why pay them homage, why make offerings, why show them reverence?" On the other hand, those who are few in number who cultivate roots of virtue, who come forth with abundant prior preparedness, who are endowed with moral discipline and have a virtuous character — only those few will rely upon such monks, draw close to them, and pay them reverence.

Kāśyapa, teachings such as these, teachings that accord with the proper standard — teachings of this kind will please two kinds of persons: those who see the truth and look upon saṃsāra with fear, and those who strive in the practice of Yogācāra and wish to attain its fruit, who rely on the karmic maturation of actions, who pursue Dharma and desire the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, those who lack striving, who hold wrong views, who run counter to the karmic maturation of actions, who do not look with fear upon the moral transgression of the world beyond, who are devoted to this present life and not devoted to future lives — all of them are to be described under this heading.

Kāśyapa, as for those clever persons who do not generate even so much as a single thought endowed with liberation — I do not open the door to teachings such as these for them. Moreover, if they hear teachings such as these, they recognize them as a failure of self-cultivation and conceive the intention to revile them, saying: "These were not spoken by the Buddha; these are fabrications invented by someone else, or things that a māra (Skt. māra) concocted and set in motion." And so they lead many people astray into wrong views. They ruin themselves and they ruin others. They come to be afflicted themselves and they cause others to be afflicted. In this way, those clever persons have not entered upon the path for the benefit of themselves or for

the benefit of others.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the great compassion of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened ones — toward those persons, those lords of Dharma, who take this enumeration of Dharma called the Heap of Jewels earnestly to heart: that compassion has been proclaimed fully and extensively. Blessed One, those sentient beings who hear this enumeration of Dharma, who have faith in it, and who practice it exactly as it is — they are fully embraced by the buddhas."

The Blessed One declared: "Kāśyapa, that is so. That is just so. Those sentient beings who hear this enumeration of Dharma, have faith in it, and practice it exactly as it is — they are fully embraced by the buddhas."

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, for the sake of those sons of good family and daughters of good family who have cultivated roots of virtue, who desire peace, who desire liberation, you must take up this chapter of Dharma. Both laypeople and those who have gone forth, having trained in this Dharma and thoroughly abandoned all the aggregates, will attain nirvāṇa."

Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, if I am to take up this enumeration of Dharma — Blessed One, what is the name of this enumeration of Dharma, and how shall I take it up?"

The Blessed One declared:

"Ānanda, therefore take up this enumeration of Dharma by the name 'The Perfect Compendium of All Dharmas.' Take it up also by the names 'The Abode of the Qualities of the Trained Noble Lineage,' 'The Perfect Upholding of Moral Discipline,' 'The Expulsion of Moral Degradation,' 'The Heap of Jewels,' 'The Aggregate of Jewels,' 'The Accumulation of Jewels,' and 'The Chapter of the Jewel Dharma-Gate.'"

Having spoken thus, the Blessed One finished. The venerable Mahākāśyapa, the venerable Ānanda, and the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

This concludes the forty-fourth chapter, called "The Chapter of the Aggregate of Jewels," from the noble Great Jewel Heap, the enumeration of Dharma in one hundred thousand sections.

The Indian paṇḍita Surendra-bodhi and —

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "wandering ascetic" translates dge sbyong, the Tibetan equivalent of Sanskrit śramaṇa. The text uses the term in a double sense: the interlocutor asks what makes one worthy of being called a śramaṇa, and the Blessed One's reply unpacks the term's full spiritual content. The list that follows is a standard enumeration of virtues and realizations associated with an accomplished practitioner; the passage ends mid-list in the source text as given, suggesting this fascicle continues beyond what was provided.

- The phrase rendered "seeking gain by improper means" translates a term meaning gain that is incompatible or discordant with the ascetic life, referring to the classical category of wrong livelihood for monastics. The phrase "wishing to obtain gain by means of gain" refers to the prohibited practice of leveraging gifts already received to attract further donations. The simile of the rhinoceros horn alludes to the ideal of solitary wandering found in the Khaggavisāṇa-sutta tradition. The phrase "abiding through cultivation with a mind equal to the earth" and its parallel "equal to space" are meditative similes for imperturbability and non-attachment respectively, well attested in contemplative literature.

- The phrase rendered "worldly charlatans" translates a term literally meaning "those who shout across distances in the world" — a classical idiom for wandering diviners or soothsayers who purvey esoteric spells. The rendering captures the intended sense: fraudulent worldly practitioners whose secret formulas an ascetic should not adopt.

The passage distinguishing those "whose aspiration is one of devoted conviction" as an exception to the condemnation of turbid wearers of the ochre robe reflects a nuanced doctrinal point: sincerity of intention is recognized even where inner purification is incomplete.

- The phrase rendered "feeble-minded sentient beings" for རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ is a standard Vinaya-literature term designating beings of inferior or stunted capacity, here used as a qualifier for a particular class of hell realm. Some translators render it "short-lived" (taking རྒྱུ་མཚན་ in a temporal sense), but the contextual sense of morally or spiritually deficient beings is more consistent with the doctrinal usage here.

The phrase "the saliva's ash" or "mere spitting of saliva's ash" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, literally "a mere particle/ash of spittle" — an idiom for something utterly negligible. The rhetorical force is: even so tiny an act upon the earth that was consecrated for the virtuous is impermissible for the impostor.

- The phrase rendered "those who are endowed and those who are liberated" translates "Idan pa dang grol ba," which in the Yogācāra monastic context likely refers to monks endowed with meditative attainment (samādhi) and those liberated through wisdom respectively. The commentarial tradition may specify these more precisely, but the bare Tibetan here is not more explicit.

The expression "a hundredth part of a hair's tip" renders a compound meaning an extremely small fraction, not a literal mathematical hundredth; the idiom is a standard hyperbolic diminutive.

- The phrase rendered "speaking harshly without restraint" translates a term sometimes rendered as "speaking endlessly" or "chattering"; the crow simile that follows it suggests shameless or scavenging speech, and the two are likely a paired set characterizing low, indiscriminating talkativeness. The exact nuance of "mu chor smar ba" (lit. "speaking to the point of overflowing/babbling") is contextually understood as unrestrained, incessant speech.

The "ninety-five wonders" is a fixed number in the text and refers to ninety-five kinds of marvels or wondrous things; its exact referent in the Indian tradition is not entirely clear from context alone, but it functions rhetorically to say that even the most astonishing external forces cannot destroy the teaching — only internal corruption can.

- The phrase rendered "speaking the secrets of worldly outcasts" translates a Tibetan term for those who dwell far from the world or beyond its pale — possibly referring to those outside the pale of civilization or the religious community whose secret words are then passed on. The sense is of spreading gossip or intimate information belonging to lay society.

The expression "feigning to carry a fly-whisk" in the section on bodily feigning likely refers to carrying the monastic fly-whisk or staff as an outward show of monastic decorum without the inner quality of genuine shame and restraint.

The phrase "medicine to be strained and discarded" refers to filtered water or strained medicine used as a monastic ascetic practice — carried out as an outward show without seeking the true medicine of Dharma teaching.

- The term rendered "person of high standing" translates "che ge mo" (literally a term of address denoting a dignitary, nobleman, or patron of high social rank). The rendering captures the social dynamic: the hypocritical monk flatters himself by invoking the prestige of his patron to justify his own status and the gains he expects to receive.

The phrase "divine-eyed ones" renders "lha mig can," literally "those who have the divine eye," referring to beings with clairvoyant vision, whether gods or humans who have attained such powers — included here to stress that even supernaturally perceptive beings are being deceived by the feigning monk's outward appearance.

- The term rendered "humble and crouching low" translates the reduplicated Tibetan expression meaning to shrink, cower, or make oneself small — capturing both the physical posture of humility and the moral cowardice of concealing one's faults. The image is of a social outcaste who bows and shrinks before entering homes to beg, here applied to a morally corrupt monk who performs outward humility while hiding inner corruption.

The word "kuraṇḍaka" at the close is a Sanskrit loanword retained in Tibetan transliteration. The passage breaks off before the analogy is explained; the meaning will be clarified in the continuation.

- The term rendered "baraka plant" translates a Tibetan phonetic rendering of what may be a Sanskrit botanical name; the precise plant is uncertain but the sense is clear: a root with a notoriously foul smell, contrasted with the flower's pleasant appearance.

The Prātimokṣa sūtra (here rendered as "Prātimokṣa sūtra" for transparency) refers to the monastic code recited at the poṣadha ceremony; expulsion from its recitation is a significant communal sanction indicating known violation of the vows.

- The phrase rendered "empty husk" for "shin te ma" follows the grain simile provided in the text: the Tibetan literally means something like "not full" or "chaff," and in context clearly denotes an insubstantial, spiritually empty religious practitioner. The simile of husked, unripened grain makes this rendering secure.

The term translated "great whetstone iron" is a somewhat unusual metallurgical reference; the Tibetan "ra gan chen po" likely refers to a type of refined iron or slag-processed metal that, while burnished to a gold-like sheen, is not genuine gold — the doctrinal point being the distinction between outward appearance and intrinsic quality.

- The seven forms of pride listed here follow a standard Abhidharma enumeration. The Tibetan terms are rendered according to their doctrinal content: ordinary pride, great pride, pride greater than pride, the pride of "I" (asmimāna), arrogant pride, a little pride, and distorted

pride. Some lists in different sources vary slightly in ordering or naming; the rendering here follows what the Tibetan text presents.

The phrase rendered "no luster of certainty" translates a compound that literally refers to luster of generosity, of right restraint (samvara), and of certainty or resolution — the three are linked in the Tibetan but separated here for clarity in English.

- The term rendered "Mātṛkā texts" translates the Tibetan for what is held in Abhidharma tradition; it refers to the matrix-texts or numerical lists that form the basis of Abhidharma literature. Some editions read this as a proper category of scriptural holding alongside Vinaya.

The phrase "great and self-possessed ones" renders the Tibetan for monks of lofty self-possession or high standing, describing the Yogācāra monks who returned to lay life.

- The term rendered "holders of the Mātṛkā" translates the Tibetan ma mo 'dzin pa, which here almost certainly refers to those who hold the Mātṛkā, the summaries or numerical matrices underlying Abhidharma, rather than the deity Mātṛkā. This is the standard Vinaya-literature usage of the term alongside "holders of the Vinaya."

The phrase rendered "whatever comes to hand in writing" (yi gar 'ong ba) is somewhat elliptical; it likely refers to written materials or texts that reach the practitioner, provided to support his study and practice.

- The phrase rendered "seeks the support of donors and benefactors" translates the Tibetan term for those who make offerings and those who are patrons or sponsors respectively, a standard pair in Vinaya literature. The distinction between the two is conventional rather than consequential here.

The phrase "fields of generosity" renders a Tibetan technical term for those who, by virtue of their moral and spiritual qualities, are worthy recipients of offerings and are said to generate merit for the giver as a field generates a harvest.

- The name of the hungry ghost realm, rendered here as "Filth-Given-at-Dusk," is a literal rendering of the Tibetan which appears to describe a realm characterized by excrement or filth and by the motif of food shown but withheld or spoiled — a fitting emblem for the misdeed of hoarding Saṅgha gains and giving grudgingly only at dusk or not at all. The precise Sanskrit name is not recoverable from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase rendered "once in every hundred occasions" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning roughly "one time in a hundred" — that is, extremely rarely — and is idiomatic rather than strictly arithmetical.

- The term "gandharvas" renders Tibetan dri za, literally "scent-eaters," the Sanskrit gandharva class of semi-divine beings associated with music and fragrance.

The phrase rendered "no support, nothing that is mine, nothing to cling to" translates rten pa med, bdag gi med, yongs su 'dzin pa med — a triad indicating the absence of refuge, ownership, and appropriation, which together underscore the forest-dweller's radical solitude and the absence of any worldly anchor.

- The list of meditative qualities at the opening continues a long enumeration of practices; the passage moves from the thirty-seven factors of awakening into behavioral instructions for a forest monk. The seven branches of awakening (byang chub kyi yan lag bdun, Skt. saptabodhyaṅga) and the noble eightfold path (ārya aṣṭāṅgamārga) are standard Abhidharma enumerations rendered according to the house glossary. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the close, as this is a partial passage. The phrase rendered "armor of the Dharma" (chos kyi go cha) is a deliberate metaphor in the text parallel to the earlier "armor" imagery; it is not a fixed technical term but a vivid figure that the text itself then unpacks.

- The phrase rendered "eighty thousand kinds of small organisms" refers to the traditional

Indian medical and cosmological notion that the human body contains eighty thousand types of tiny living beings dependent on it for sustenance; the bodhisattva's dedication of his food to their wellbeing is a recurring motif in texts of this genre.

The term rendered "non-human being" covers a wide range of entities in Indian Buddhist cosmology, including spirits, yakṣas, and other supernatural presences that might haunt forest hermitages; the text deliberately leaves the category open.

- The phrase rendered "without clinging" for "len pa med par" reflects the standard Tibetan idiom indicating liberation without residue or grasping — technically, liberation as an arhat without remainder. This is a standard colophon formula for such passages.

The closing sentence is cut off in the source text and the translation renders it up to the natural break, as the passage ends mid-sentence with the opening of the next section on the alms-round monk.

- The phrase rendered "go in orderly sequence" translates a technical instruction for alms-round practice, indicating that the monk proceeds house by house in order without skipping households to seek better food.

The long sequence of "may it not be" clauses is a deliberate rhetorical device enumerating the unwholesome expectations a monk must resolve to be free of before entering on his alms round; the translation preserves this parallel structure faithfully.

- The text ends mid-sentence at "fragrance-eaters (gandharvas)" — this is a passage break, not a complete syntactic unit, and the narration continues in the next segment. The Tibetan term "གྲངས་པ་འཕྲུལ་པ་" literally means "fragrance-eaters," the standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit gandharva.

- The phrase rendered "easy to satisfy" translates a perception of being one who requires little, which in the commentarial tradition means being content with whatever minimum sustenance one receives, paired with contentment as such — these are classic paired virtues of the ascetic. The distinction is subtle but meaningful and is preserved here.

- The phrase rendered "the wanderer called Suprabha" translates the Tibetan term "kun du rgyu rab tu bzang po," which literally means "the excellent wanderer" and appears to be a proper name — Suprabha or Suvrata — functioning as a contrast figure to the disciplined novice. The exact Sanskrit original of this name is uncertain.

The phrase "bowed down with five limbs touching the ground" renders "yan lag lngas phyag 'tshal," the traditional prostration in which both knees, both palms, and the forehead touch the ground — a standard honorific gesture of the highest reverence.

- The list of fabrics — Kāśika, Dukūla, Kautamba — are well-attested Indian luxury textiles known from Sanskrit sources; "Kāśika" denotes fine Benares cloth, "Dukūla" a type of fine linen or bark-cloth, and "Kautamba" a silk or fine cotton. The Tibetan term rendered "hempen cloth" (sha na'i ras) may refer to a coarse cloth made from hemp or similar plant fiber, conventional garb of the frugal ascetic; the precise identification is uncertain but the contrast with luxury fabrics is the doctrinal point.

The phrase rendered "depicted in images" (ri mo byed) literally means "painted" or "portrayed," suggesting the making of portraits or icons of such monks — a sign of popular veneration the text treats as symptomatic of their corruption rather than genuine virtue.

- The phrase rendered "lords of Dharma" translates chos kyi dbang phyug, a term meaning one who has mastery or sovereignty over the Dharma, here referring to devoted practitioners who uphold the teaching. The context suggests these are serious practitioners rather than a formal title, but the rendering preserves the doctrinal flavor of the term.

The expression "clever persons" for *mi gti mug pa* is slightly paradoxical in Tibetan — literally "those who are not bewildered" or "the non-deluded" — but the context makes clear it is used ironically: these are worldly-clever people who nonetheless lack spiritual understanding. This ironic usage is a genuine interpretive point worth flagging.

- The passage ends mid-sentence with the colophon naming the Indian paṇḍita Surendra-bodhi, whose Tibetan collaborator's name would have followed but is not included in the supplied text. This is the standard closing colophon formula for a translation team and is not a problem with the source; the extract simply cuts off there.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.